Problem Statement: New Admins Stall Before Their First Invitation | Prepared by Jordan Lee

The Problem

New Nexus workspace admins set up alone and stall. In the day-30 onboarding cohort, 38% of new workspaces have invited no one at day 14, and those workspaces are the ones that go quiet: an admin working alone has no one to assign a task to, no reason to return tomorrow, and no experience of the collaboration the product exists for. Setup asks the admin to make every decision at once, project structure, first tasks, who to invite, with nothing started for them. Admins need a guided way to reach their first invitation and their first assigned task in the first session, before the workspace goes cold.

Who Has It

New workspace admins in their first two weeks. The evidence below comes from trial workspaces created in August and September 2026, which is also where the stall is worst: admins on paid plans, who arrive with a project already chosen by their employer, invite sooner.

Evidence

- 38% of trial workspaces created in August and September 2026 had zero invited teammates at day 14 (product analytics, cohort export, October 2026).
- Workspaces with no invitation by day 14 were one third as likely to still be active at day 60 as workspaces that invited in week 1.
- In the day-30 survey, setup time is the most named stall point in open answers.
- One admin told his account manager the setup felt like "being handed an empty warehouse and a clipboard."

What It Costs

Every stalled workspace is a trial that evaluates Nexus as a solo note-taking tool and finds it unremarkable. The invite is the moment the product's value becomes visible; a first month spent alone is the main reason trial workspaces lapse quietly instead of converting or churning loudly.

What We Are Not Solving

We are not solving activation for individual users who join an existing workspace (their first run is a different problem, owned by the onboarding team), and we are not solving reactivation of workspaces dormant for more than a quarter.